



Security Superheroes

Two tech-whiz IITians develop ground-breaking solutions to ward off security threats

Renuka Rane

When an educational institute claimed that its physically segregated virtual network for students, employees and administrators could not be penetrated, a handful of IIT graduates proved it wrong. Having only the privilege and rights a student is entitled to, the team accessed a guest account, entered the administrators' network, then the students' and finally the employees' network.

The team is from iViz Techno Solutions (www.iviztechnosolutions.com), a technology-driven products and solutions company conceived and based in IIT Kharagpur (IIT-K), West Bengal. iViz is a part of IIT-K's incubation programme, wherein graduates who would like to start a venture of their own are provided infrastructure support. The company provides managed security services, anti-spam consultancy, Web and database security assessment, forensics and data recovery.

The Pioneers

The duo behind iViz are just in their twenties—and they have their quirks. Bikash Barai, 23, has a penchant for unconventional magic tricks, and enjoys the works of Swami Vivekanand and Netaji Subashchandra Bose. Nilanjan De, 25, enjoys science-fiction and is a confirmed night person.

Barai, head of business development at iViz, has always been deeply interested in anti-spam technology, network and wireless security, cognitive hacking and social engineering. He jointly holds several patents on anti-spam technologies. And so does De, now CTO of iViz. An electronics and electrical communication engineer from IIT-K, De is by now a known name in network security.

The IIT Aura

Barai expalins, "iViz stands for 'intelligent vision'. We conceptualised this company in late 2003 when I was in my third year B.Tech. in computer engineering and De was a GRA (Graduate Research Assistant) at IIT-K. We had a grand vision of making computing free from all security threats. We got our company incorporated as 'iViz Techno Solutions' in February 2004."

iViz has a full-fledged office on campus. Apart from Barai and De, the core technical team includes current IIT students Rudra Sinha Roy, an expert in penetration testing (see box on facing page), and Abhishek Dutta, a specialist in exploitation techniques. As of now, iViz has five full-time and 15 part-time employees and six consultants—all IIT-K alumni. Also, iViz' board of advisors has some of the most eminent educationists, professors and executives in India.

Imaging: Anu Deshmukh